D-FREE

Analysis of Practitioner-Survey for Recommended Medications in Rwanda



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Organizer

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Organization

D-FREE

Analysis of D-Free Medication Survey

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Introduction

This report aims to analyze responses from medical practitioners from local regions of Rwanda, reviewing their prior knowledge of the fourth suggested medication treatments for diarrheal diseases (ORT, Zinc Supplements, Vitamin A Supplements, and Probiotic Supplements) before specific education programs are initiated.

Oral Rehydration Therapy (ORT)

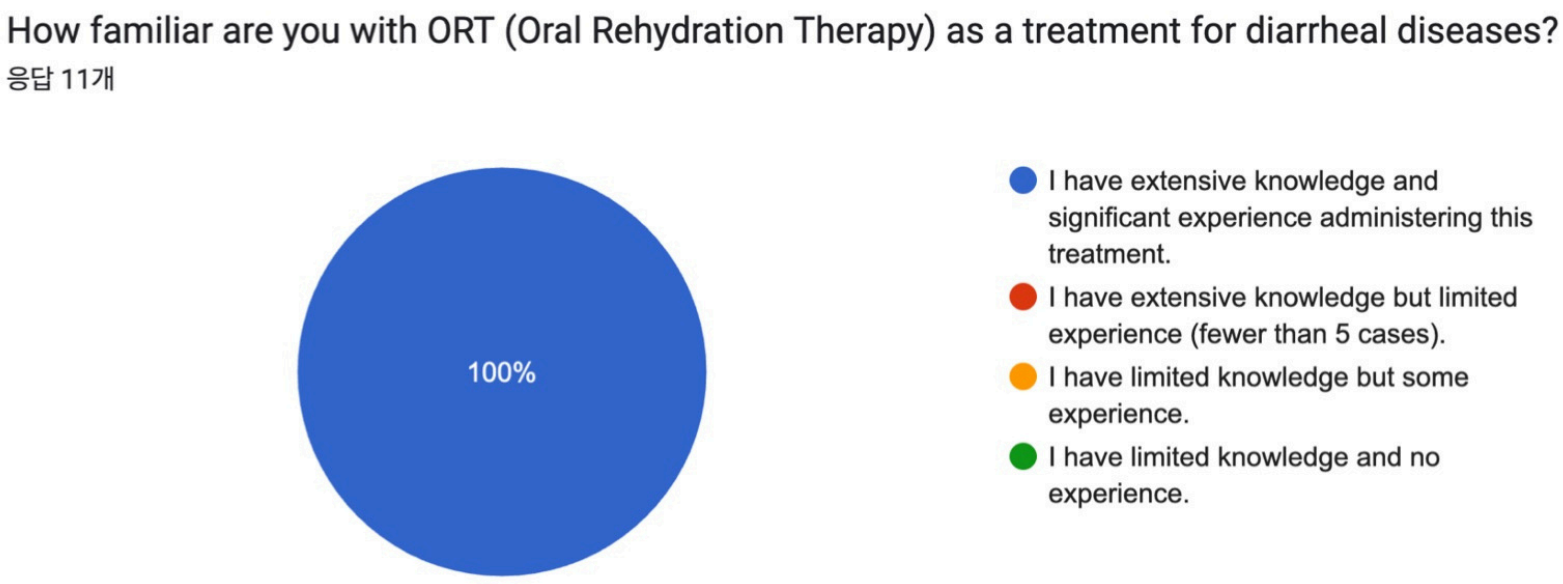


Figure 1-1.

Figure 1-1 shows that all practitioners in the organization already acknowledge the use of ORT as a treatment for diarrheal diseases - showing that they already have somewhat prior knowledge to the solution.

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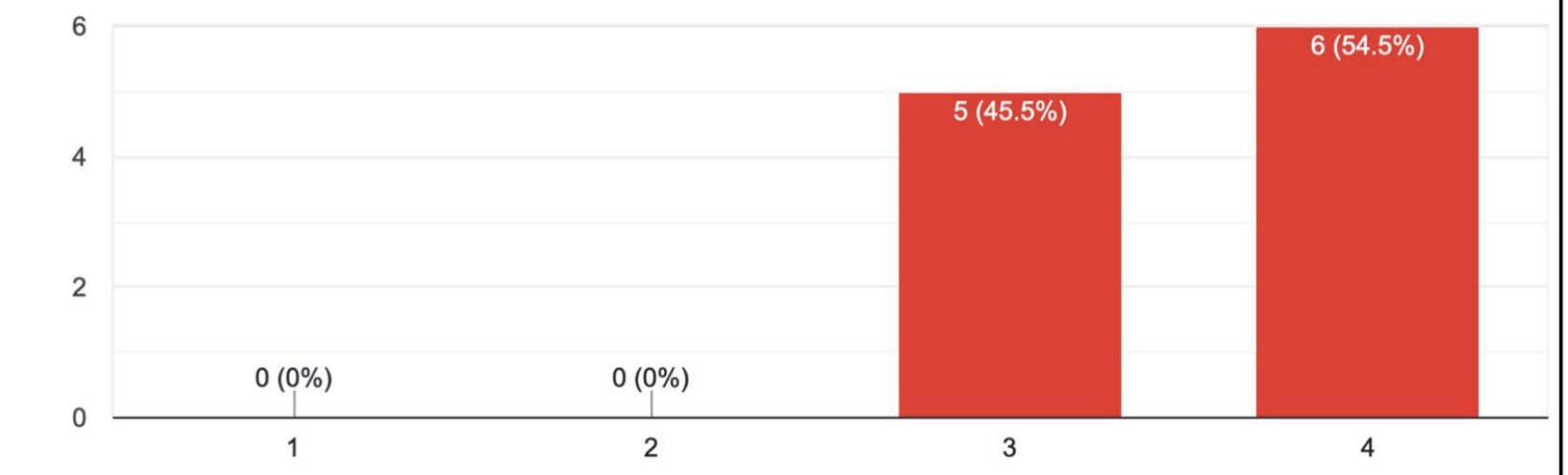


Figure 1-4.

Figure 1-4 shows that 'storage and handling requirements' of the treatment is an area of priority for further education. Although approximately half (54.5%) of the practitioners responded with having excellent knowledge on the issue, the other approximate half (45.5%) were relatively unfamiliar with it - a much higher proportion of a lower scale than '4' compared to other areas of questions from the survey.

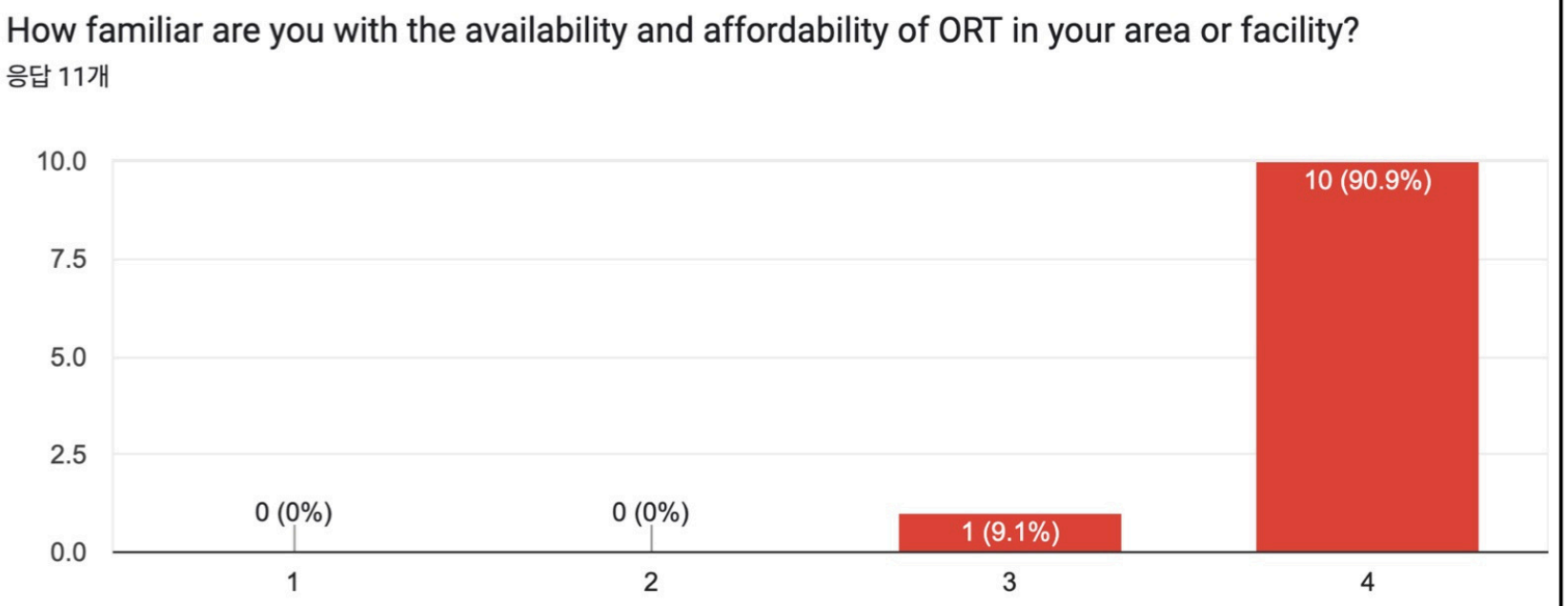


Figure 1-5.

Figure 1-5 shows that almost all practitioners (90.9%) have extensive knowledge about the availability and affordability of the treatment in their currently located organizations - as expected. However, one practitioner (9.1%), similar to figure 1-2, shows a relatively slight lack of knowledge on this issue. Hence, a quick overview of the availability and affordability is required as well.

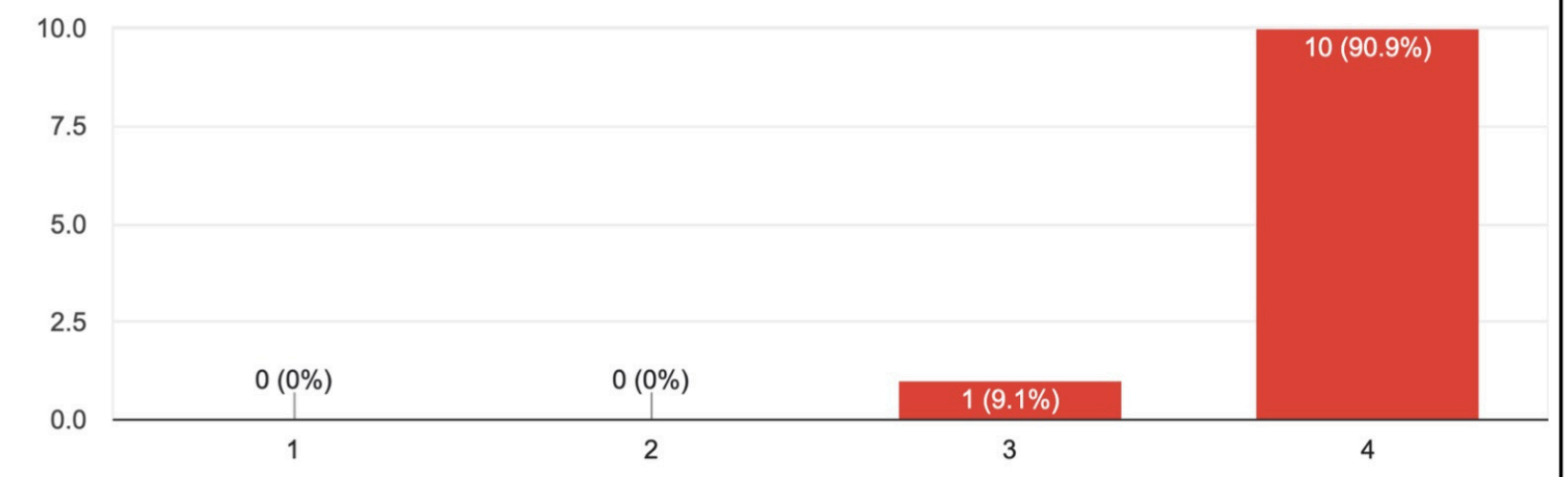


Figure 1-2.

Figure 1-2 shows that almost all practitioners (90.9%) are highly familiar and experts of the proper usage of ORT treatments. However, one practitioner responded as relatively unfamiliar with the issue (9.1%); hence, though not highly in-depth and time-spending, a quick overview of the proper dosage and administration education should be needed.

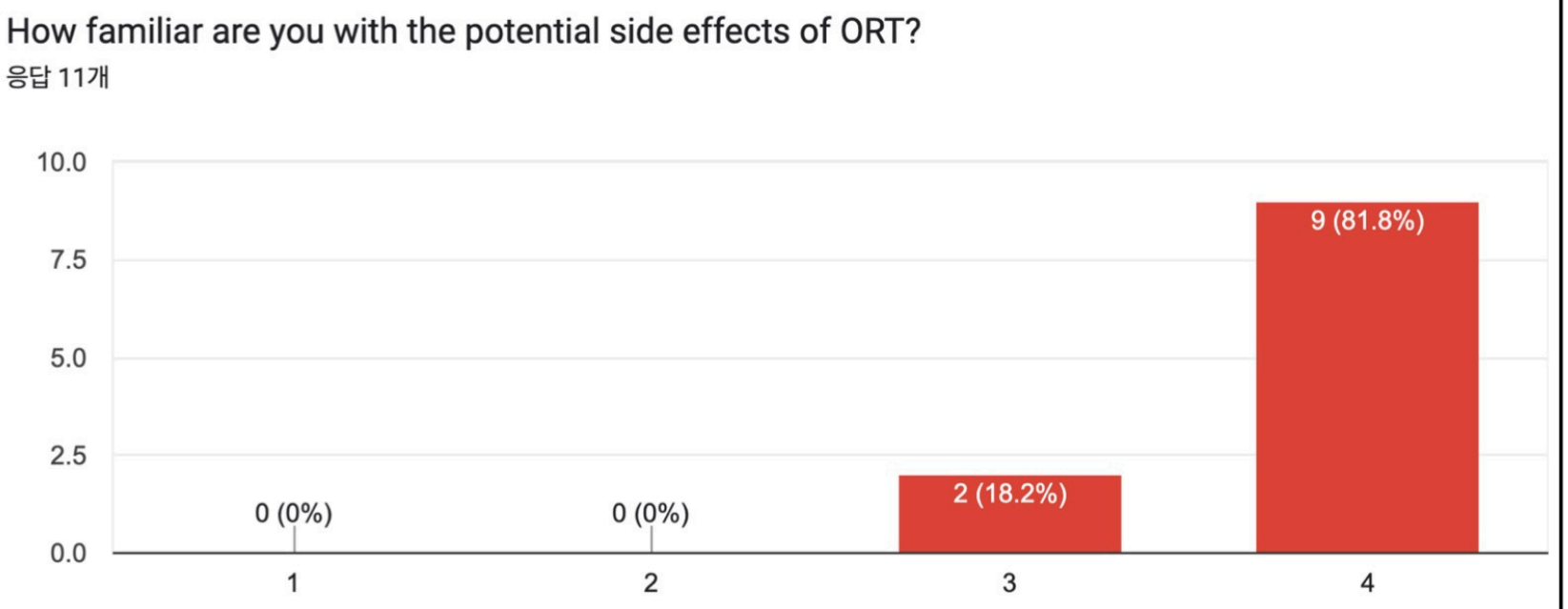


Figure 1-3.

Figure 1-3 shows that most practitioners (81.8%) in the organization are capable of acknowledging the side effects of ORT and would not show a shock response to unexpected situations where the side effects are present. However, two out of eleven respondents do not show a full acknowledgement of the potential side effects; hence, a slight improvement of education is needed for more extensive knowledge towards this issue.

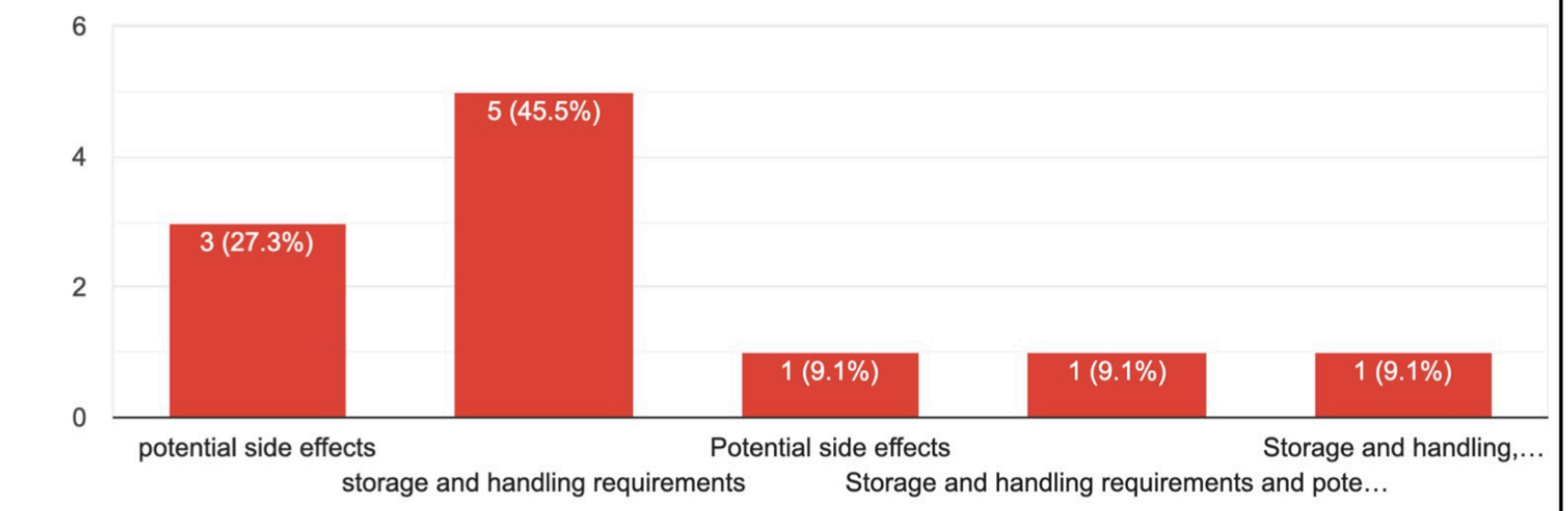


Figure 1-6.

As expected, shown by figure 1-4, figure 1-6 implies that further content and knowledge is needed especially for the storage and handling requirements of ORT. More than half of the practitioners have shown their interest to gain further knowledge from this topic.
Furthermore, reflecting figure 1-3, further education on the potential side effects of ORT is required as well for a successful usage of the treatment across places in need. Though not as a priority, improvements in education of other areas such as potential side effects should also be focused.

Overview

The survey's overall findings show that practitioners are mostly comfortable with and have a solid basic grasp of ORT as a treatment for diarrheal diseases. There are still some small gaps, though, especially in the understanding of possible adverse effects and how to handle and store the medication. The organization's preparedness to manage diarrheal care with ORT would be further strengthened by targeted, brief educational reinforcement in these areas, which would assist guarantee consistent and efficient implementation across all practitioners.

Zinc Supplements

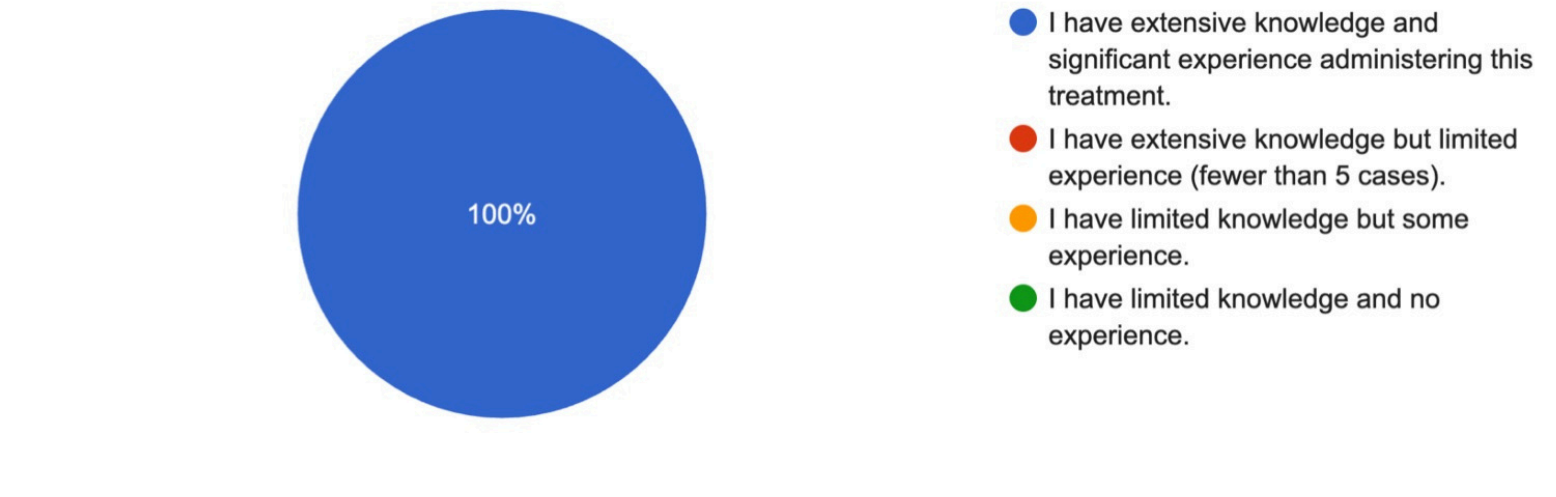


Figure 2-1.

Figure 2-1 shows that all practitioners (100%) have extensive knowledge and significant experience administering Zinc Supplements as a treatment for diarrheal diseases. This indicates a strong foundational familiarity within the organization, and no immediate education or training is necessary for this particular aspect of the treatment.

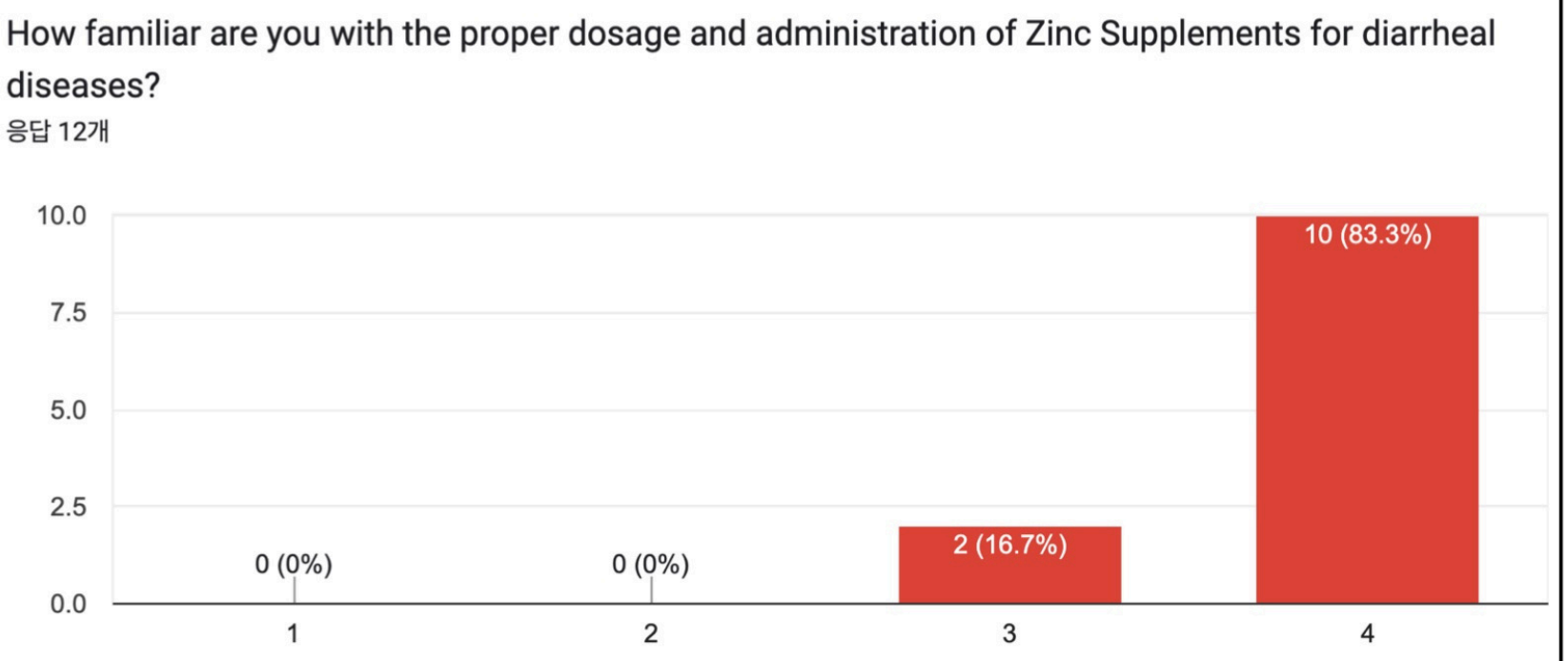


Figure 2-2.

Figure 2-2 shows that the majority of practitioners (83.3%) are highly familiar with the proper dosage and administration of Zinc Supplements for diarrheal diseases. However, two practitioners (16.7%) indicated only moderate familiarity. While overall understanding is strong, a brief review session could help ensure that all members are fully confident in accurate dosing and administration procedures.

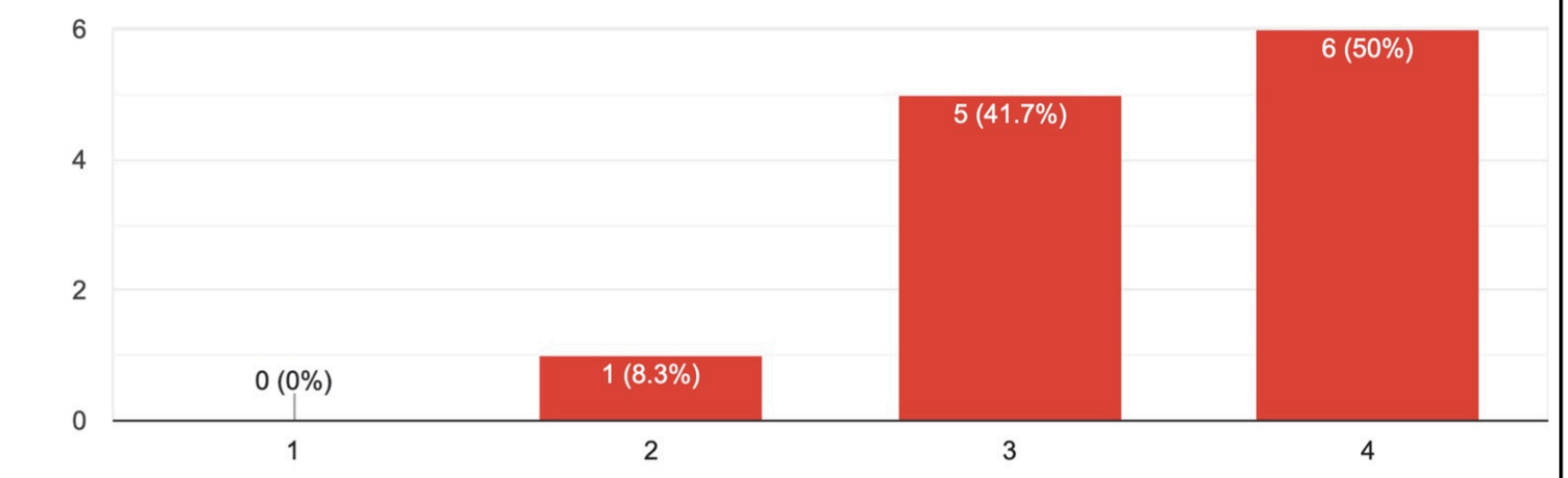


Figure 2-3.

Figure 2-3 shows that half of the practitioners (50%) are fully familiar with the potential side effects of Zinc Supplements, while 41.7% show moderate familiarity. However, one practitioner (8.3%) indicated low awareness of side effects. This suggests that although general understanding is relatively present, an educational reinforcement focused on side effects is essential to ensure consistent clinical responses across all practitioners.

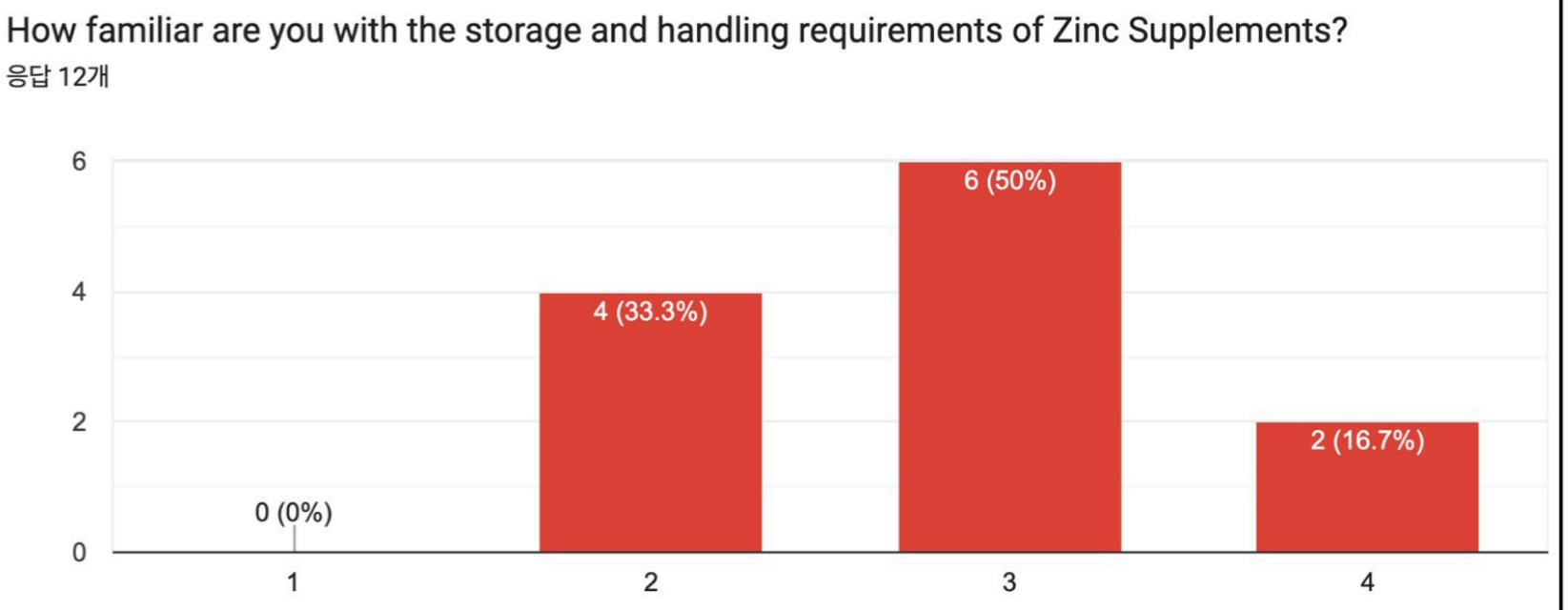


Figure 2-4.

Figure 2-4 shows that most practitioners are only moderately familiar with the storage and handling requirements of Zinc Supplements. Half of the respondents (50%) selected a mid-level familiarity, and a significant portion (33.3%) reported relatively low familiarity. Only 16.7% indicated strong confidence in this area. This suggests that storage and handling requirements of the treatment is also a clear area for improvement, and targeted training is recommended to raise overall competency across the team.

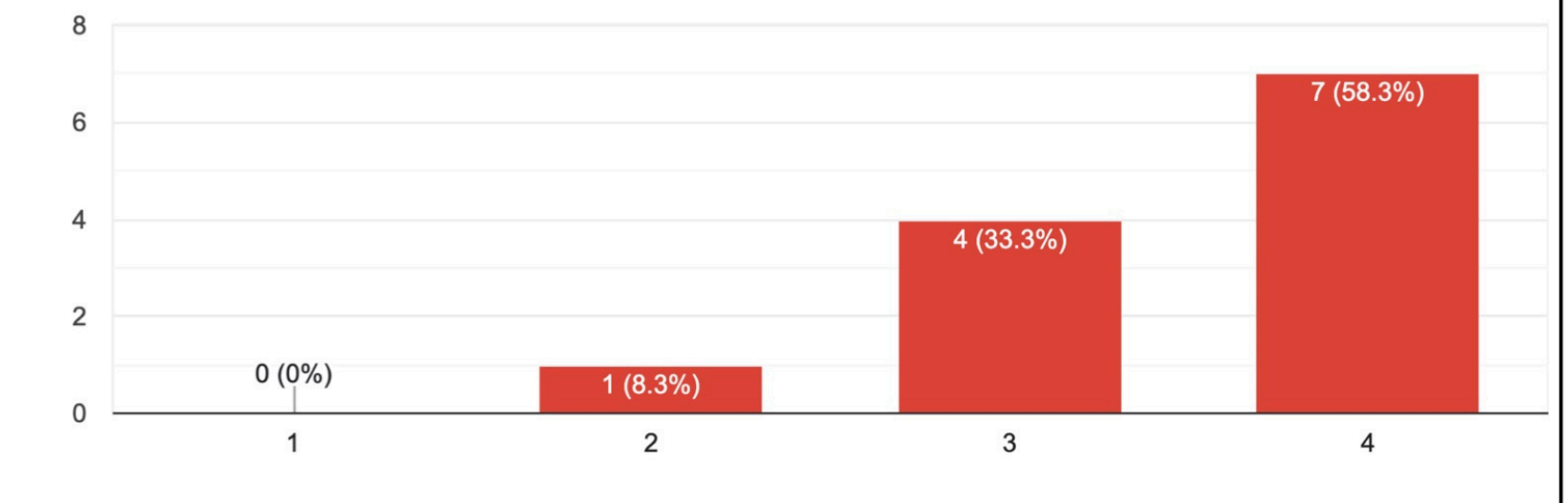


Figure 2-5.

Figure 2-5 shows that most practitioners (58.3%) are highly familiar with the availability and affordability of Zinc Supplements within their area or facility. However, one-third (33.3%) indicated moderate familiarity, while one respondent (8.3%) reported limited knowledge. Although general awareness is satisfactory, a brief clarification session or sharing of updated resource availability could help unify knowledge across all respondents.

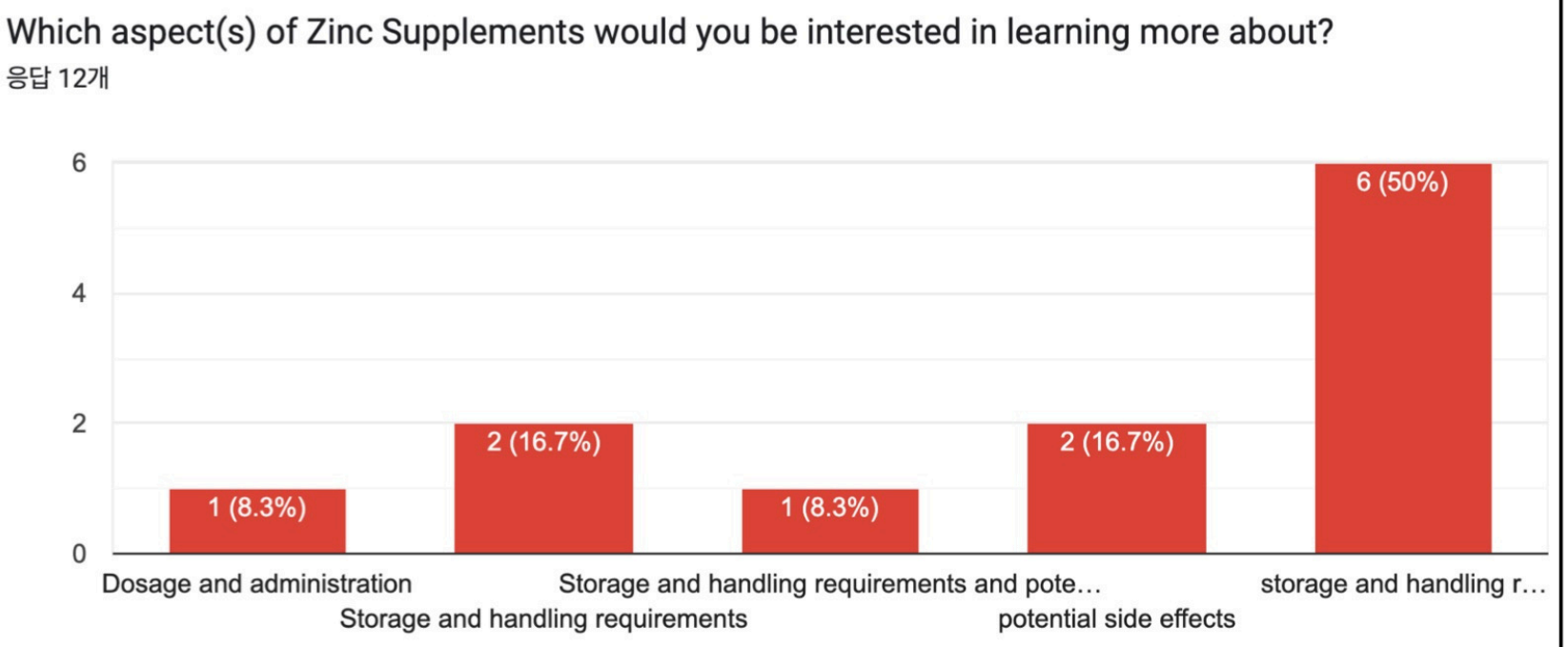


Figure 2-6.

Figure 2-6 shows that the majority of practitioners (50%) expressed interest in further learning about the storage and handling requirements of Zinc Supplements. Additional interest was also shown for combined topics like side effects and handling (16.7%) and for individual areas like potential side effects (16.7%) and dosage/administration (8.3%). These responses reinforce earlier data from Figure 2-4 and Figure 2-3, confirming that storage, handling, and side effects should be the main focus areas for future training or educational materials.

Overview

The survey overall shows that practitioners are highly knowledgeable and experienced in administering Zinc Supplements for diarrheal diseases. However, specific areas, particularly storage and handling requirements and awareness of potential side effects, emerged as notable gaps in confidence and understanding. In line with expressed interest from practitioners, targeted education in these areas is required to enhance consistency and preparedness across the team. Overall, the foundation is strong, with areas for focused improvement in specific domains.

Vitamin A Supplements

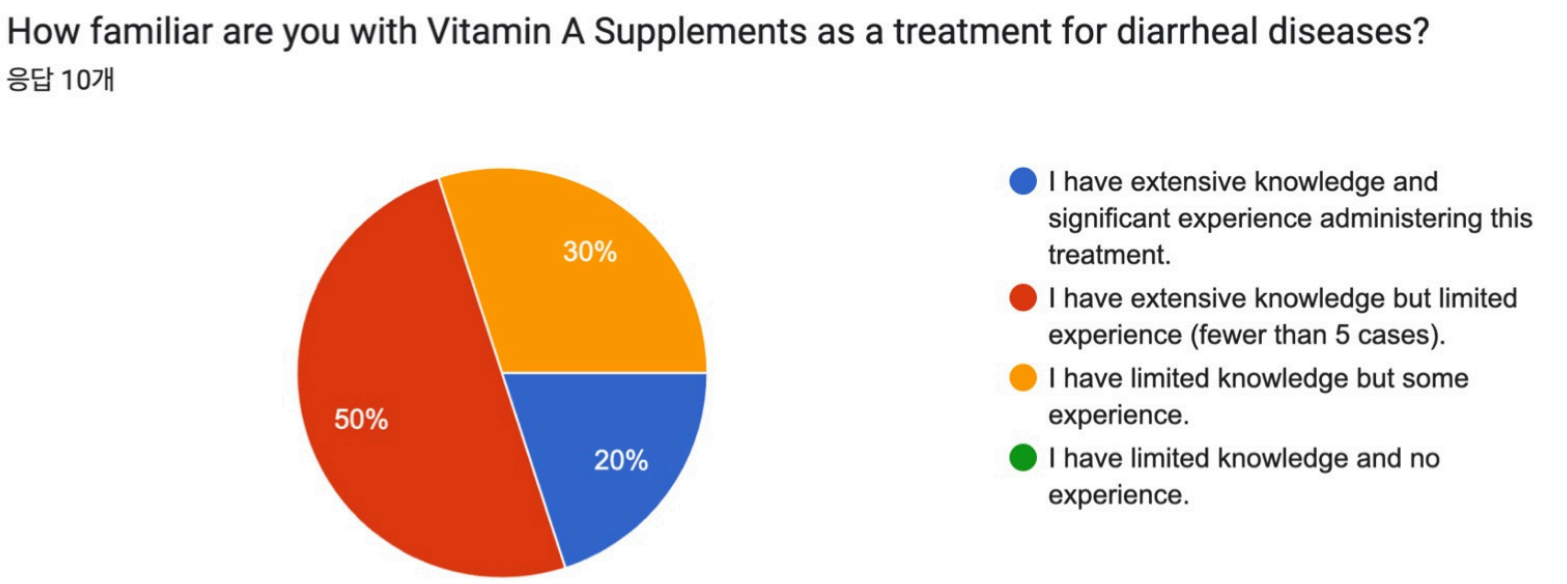


Figure 3-1.

Figure 3-1 shows that only 20% of practitioners have both extensive knowledge and significant experience using Vitamin A Supplements as a treatment for diarrheal diseases. Meanwhile, 50% report extensive knowledge but limited practical experience, and 30% indicate limited knowledge with some experience. This suggests that although theoretical understanding may be present, the practical familiarity of the issue is generally low, and a practical training session could help close the gap.

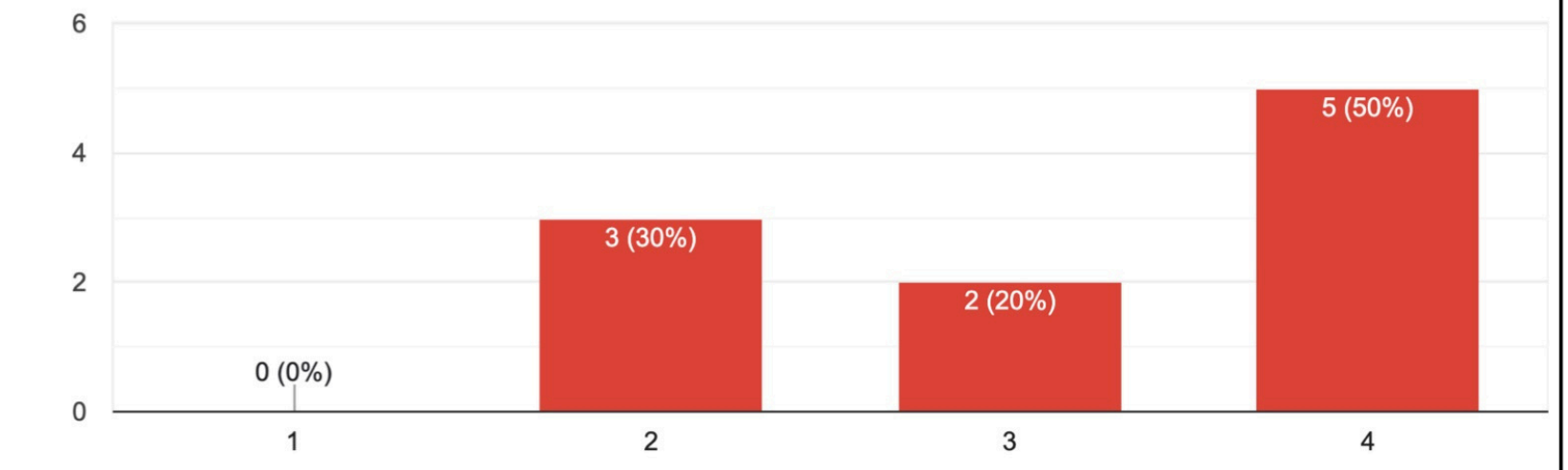


Figure 3-2.

Figure 3-2 indicates that half of the practitioners (50%) are highly familiar with the proper dosage and administration of Vitamin A Supplements. However, 30% show limited familiarity (rating 2), and 20% rate themselves at a moderate level (3). While a decent portion of the group is confident, a refresher on correct dosage protocols would be helpful to elevate overall consistency.

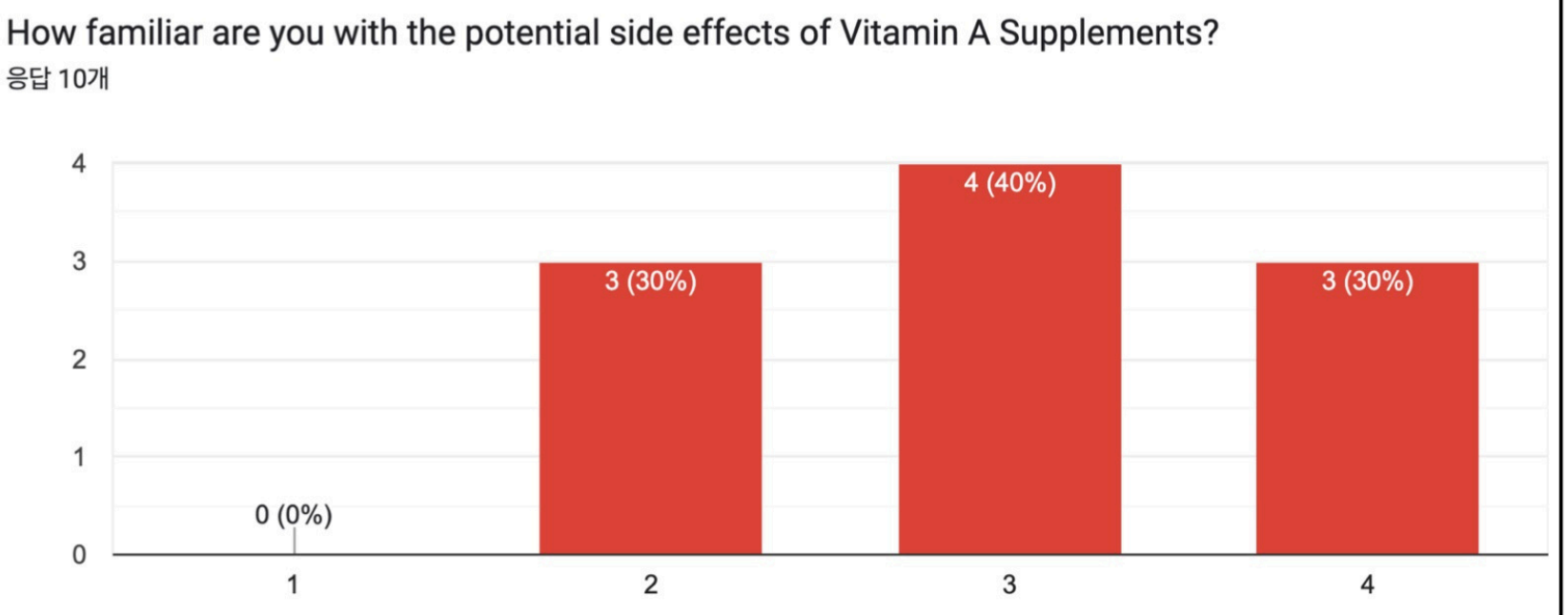


Figure 3-3.

Figure 3-3 shows that familiarity with the potential side effects of Vitamin A Supplements is fairly balanced, with 40% of respondents at a moderate level (3), and 30% each at low (2) and high (4) levels. No respondent reported complete unfamiliarity. While the group shows some awareness, the

spread suggests a need for focused education on side effects to achieve a more uniform and informed understanding.

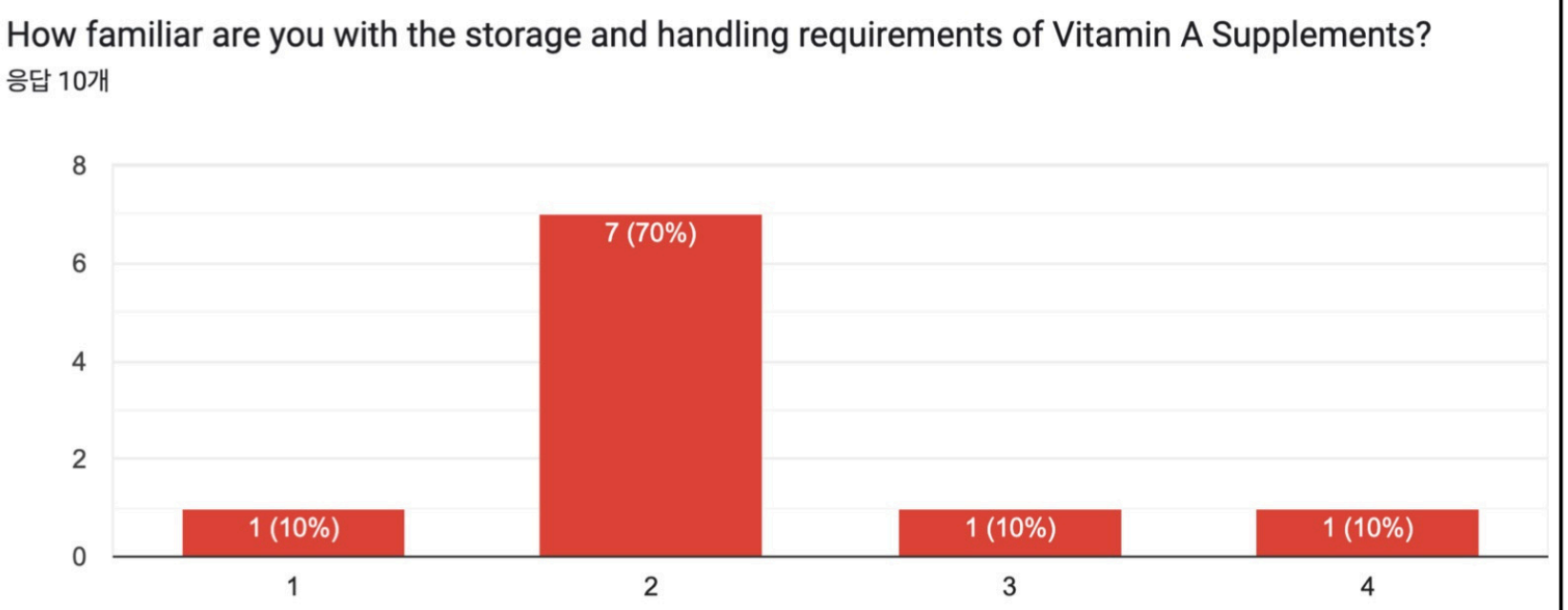


Figure 3-4.

Figure 3-4 indicates that storage and handling requirements are a significant gap in knowledge. A large majority (70%) rated their familiarity as low (2), with an additional 20% (combined) at the extremes (1 or 4). Only 10% rated moderate familiarity. This clearly marks storage and handling as a priority area for future training and resource development.

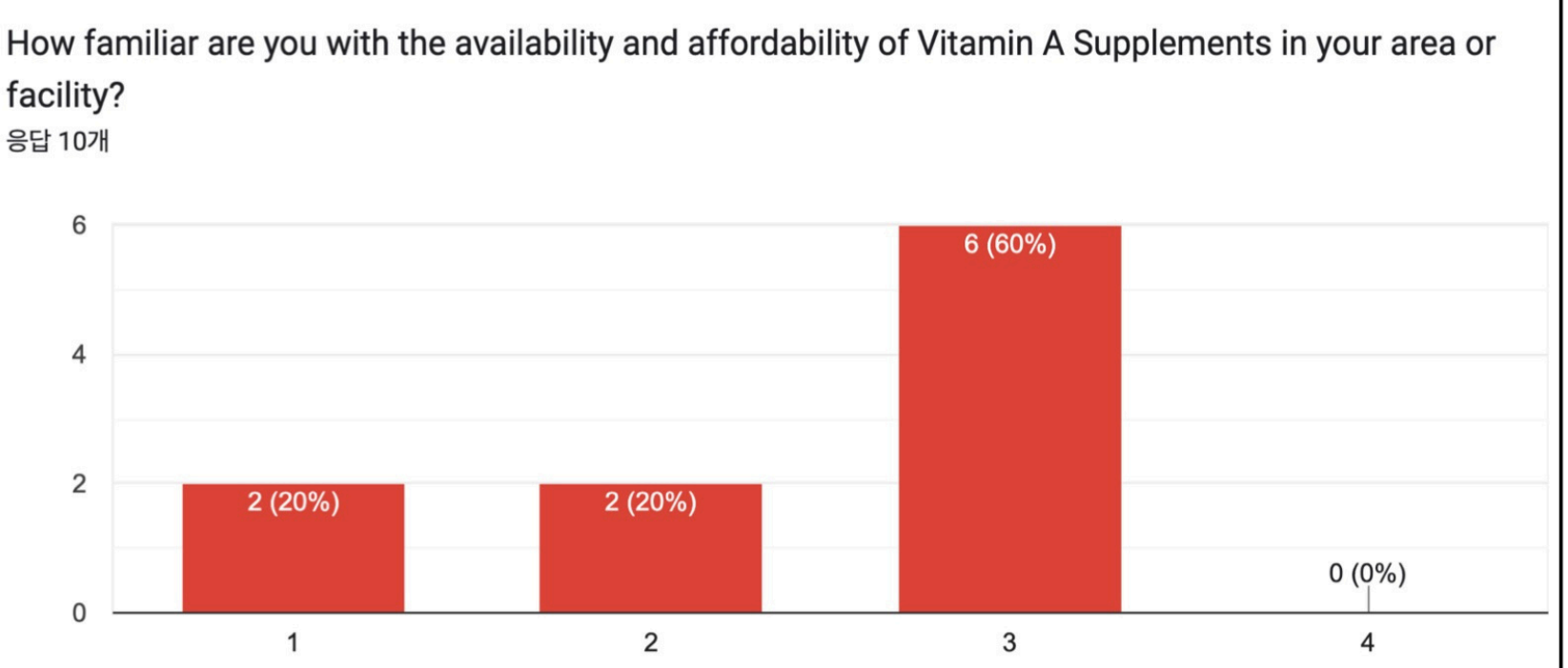


Figure 3-5.

Figure 3-5 reveals that while most respondents (60%) have moderate familiarity with the availability and affordability of Vitamin A Supplements, a notable 40% selected the lowest two levels (1 and 2). No respondent selected the highest level (4), indicating room for improvement in distribution knowledge. A quick briefing or updated supply map could effectively address this gap.

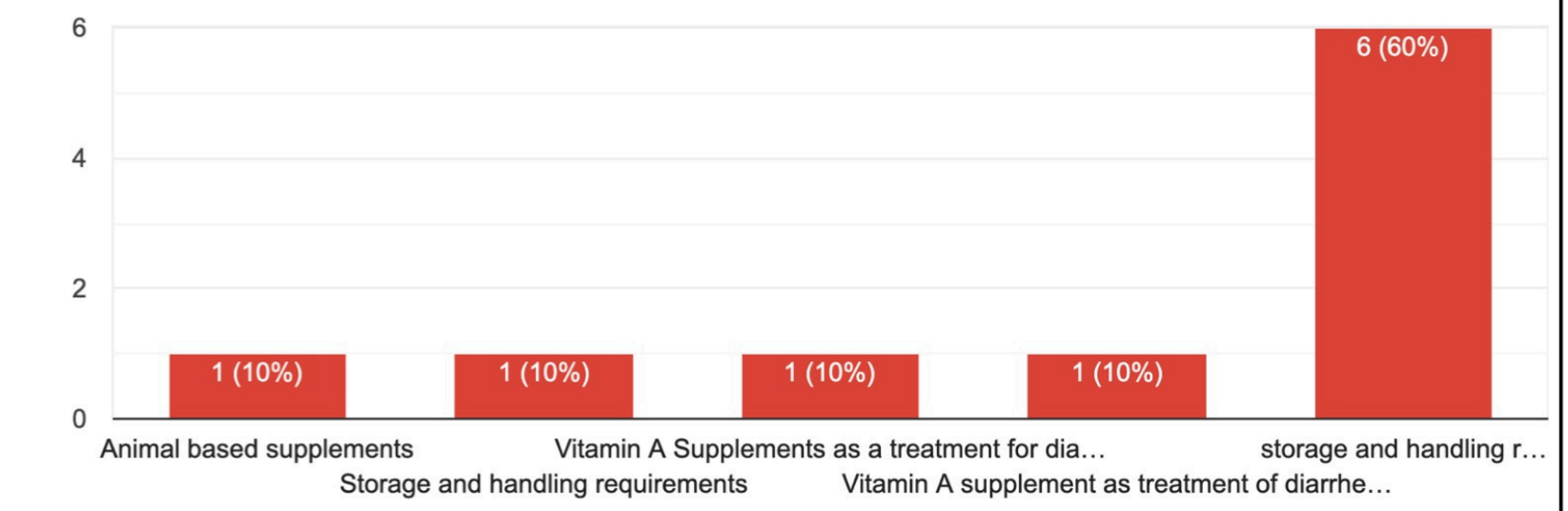


Figure 3-6.

As shown in Figure 3-6, the majority of practitioners (50%) expressed interest in further learning about the storage and handling requirements of Zinc Supplements. Additional interest was also shown for combined topics like side effects and handling (16.7%) and for individual areas like potential side effects (16.7%) and dosage/administration (8.3%). These responses reinforce earlier data from Figure 3-4 and Figure 3-3, confirming that storage, handling, and side effects should be the main focus areas for future training or educational materials.

A majority of practitioners (70%) have shown their desire to gain further knowledge specifically on storage and handling requirements of vitamin A supplements; hence, this should be a focused area of further composition of education materials. Furthermore, some practitioners showed interest in other areas such as animal based supplements, and further knowledge about vitamin A itself as a cure for diarrheal diseases. Further education in the future therefore should also contain contents based on these topics.

Overview

The survey findings underscore that while practitioners possess general awareness of Vitamin A Supplements, practical experience and applied knowledge remain limited across several key areas. Notably, storage and handling requirements emerged as the most significant gap, both in familiarity and expressed interest for further learning. In addition, side effect awareness and distribution knowledge also require further improvements. To strengthen competency and preparedness, future educational initiatives should prioritize these areas, while also incorporating additional topics of

interest raised by practitioners, such as the broader role of vitamin A in treatment and potential animal-based supplement alternatives.

Probiotic Supplements

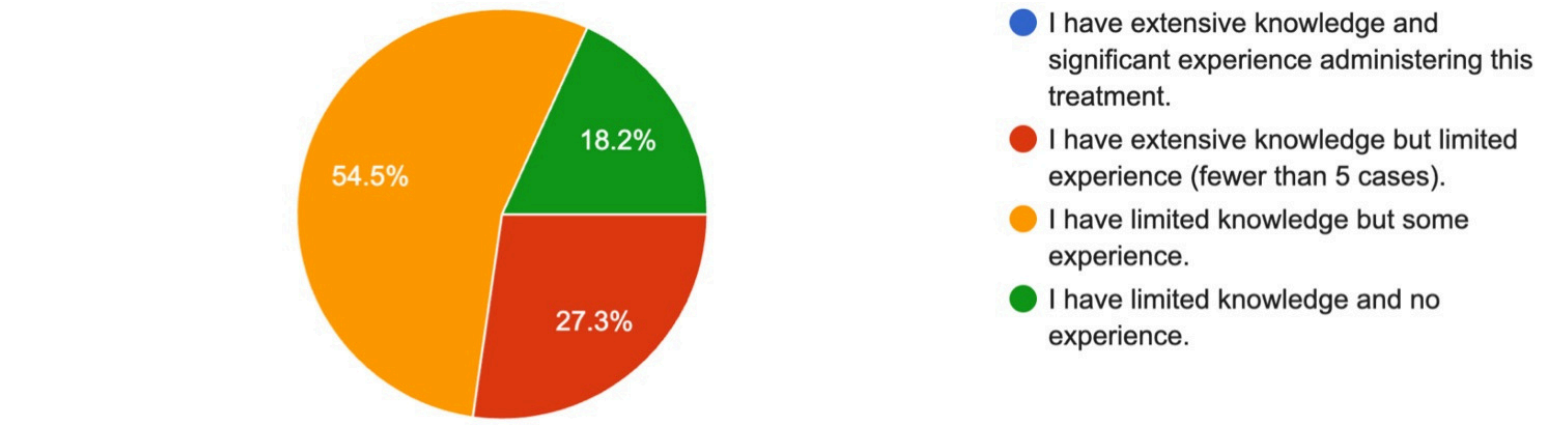


Figure 4-1.

Compared to other solutions, it is shown in figure 4-1 that most participants of the survey have limited knowledge about the usage of probiotic supplements as a treatment for diarrheal diseases. No practitioners have responded for having extensive knowledge and experience about probiotic supplement; in fact, 54.5% are shown to have limited knowledge and little experience about the treatment, 27.3% with extensive knowledge but limited experience, and 18.2% with neither. This shows that the treatment may be an area to focus on the most for further education and acquisition of knowledge.

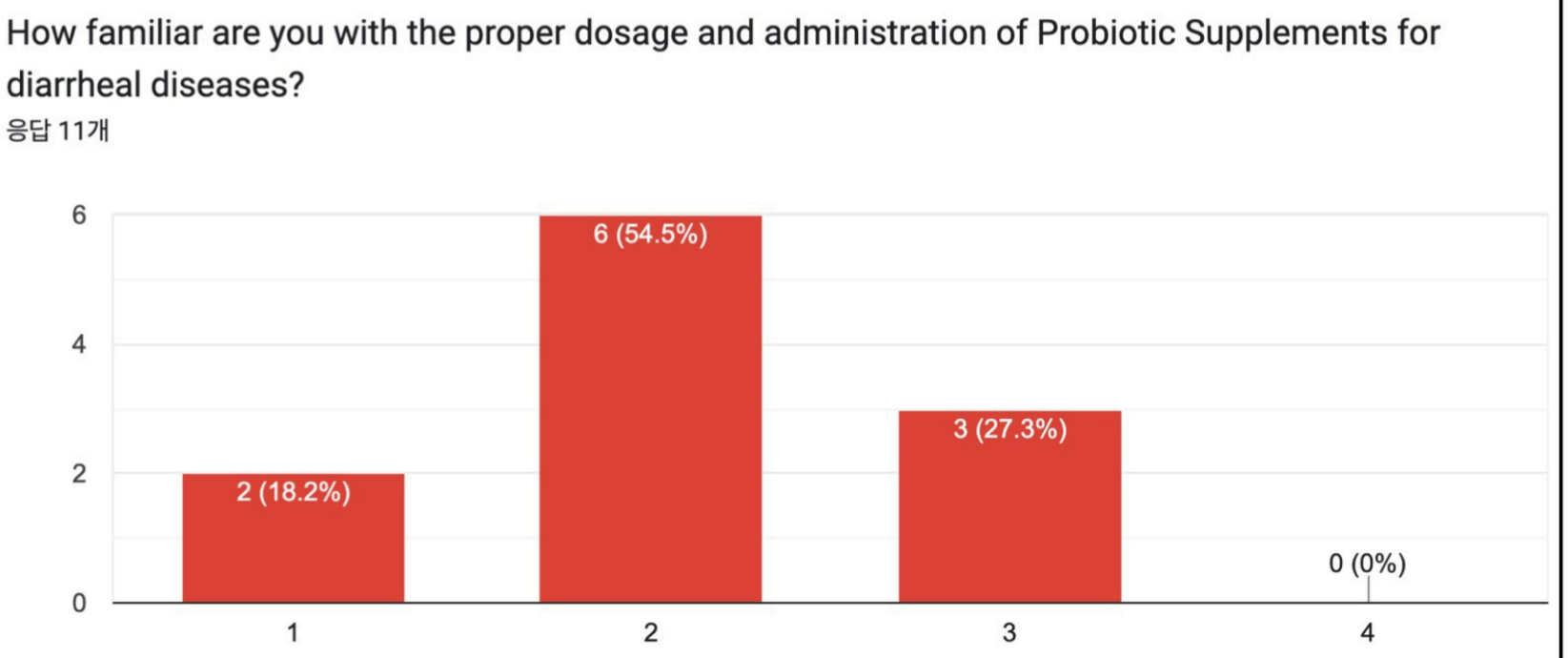


Figure 4-2.

It is shown that more than half of the practitioners (54.5%) have limited knowledge about the dosage and administration of probiotic supplements. Though 3 out of 11 practitioners (27.3%) have shown to have somewhat knowledge about the topic, 2 practitioners (18.2%) have shown to have extremely limited knowledge about the correct dosage and administration. Hence, further education for this topic is specifically required along with an overview mechanisms of probiotic supplements.

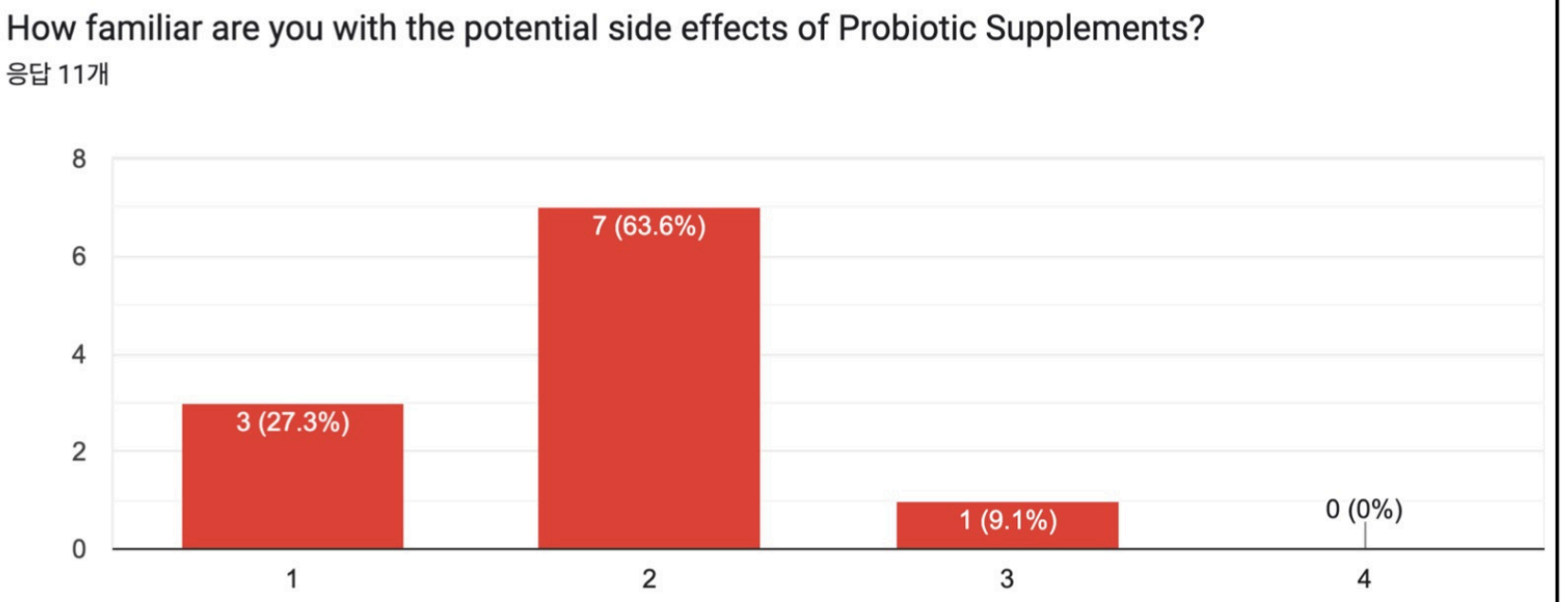


Figure 4-3.

Figure 4-3 shows that practitioners generally have limited knowledge about the potential side effects and solutions of probiotic supplements - even more compared to 'dosage and administration' of the treatment. Though one practitioner seemed to have somewhat knowledge about the side effects of the treatment, 63.6% of the practitioners responded that they are not quite familiar with the issue, while 27.3% responded that they do not have sufficient knowledge about it. This indicates that it is essential to administer the side effects of the treatments in terms of education programs.

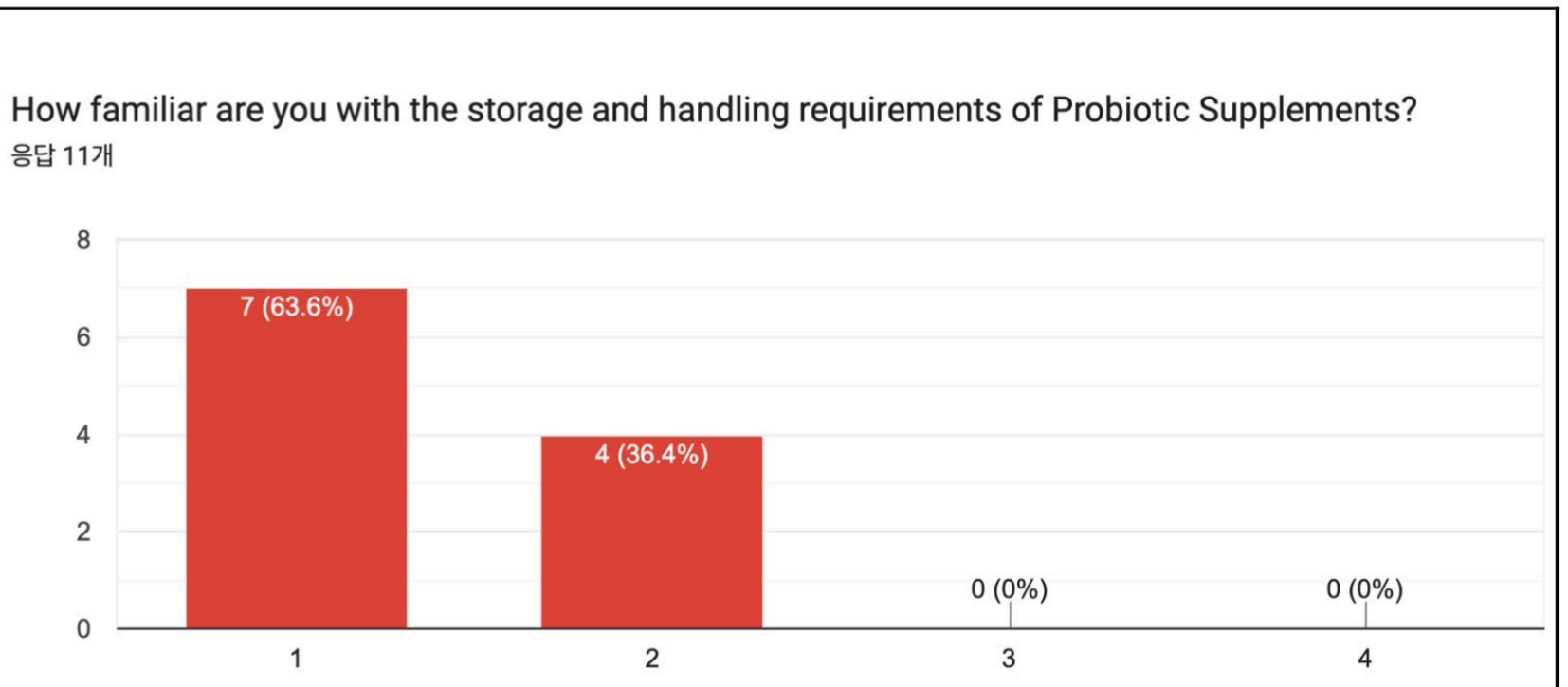


Figure 4-4.

Figure 4-4 shows that the majority of practitioners are highly unaware of the storing and handling requirements of probiotic supplements. 7 out of 11 practitioners (63.6%) have shown to have extremely limited knowledge of the issue - the lowest statistical result from any of the questions throughout all medication surveys. 4 out of 11 practitioners (36.4%) have also shown to have, although no extremely limited, inadequate knowledge of the issue. Hence, further education materials on probiotic supplements should take storage and handling requirements as priority and focus on expanding the knowledge about practitioners within this area.

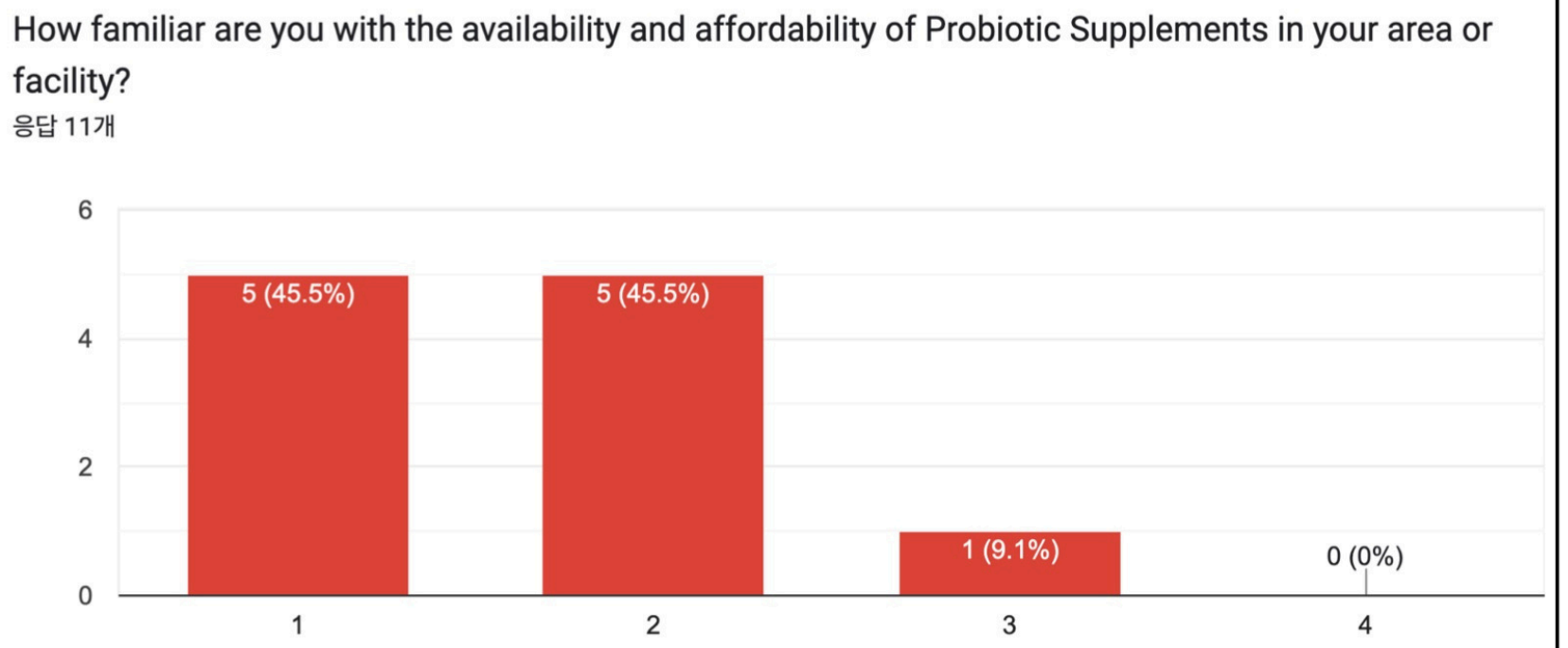


Figure 4-5.

Practitioners also show highly limited knowledge on the availability and affordability of the treatment. Though one practitioner has shown to have somewhat knowledge of the issue, a majority of them are focused in the lower half of the scale bar - 45.5% responding to have limited knowledge of the issue, while the other 45.5% responding as ‘highly insufficient.’ Hence, further education on the availability and affordability of the treatment within the region of practitioners is essential as well, and should be prioritized.

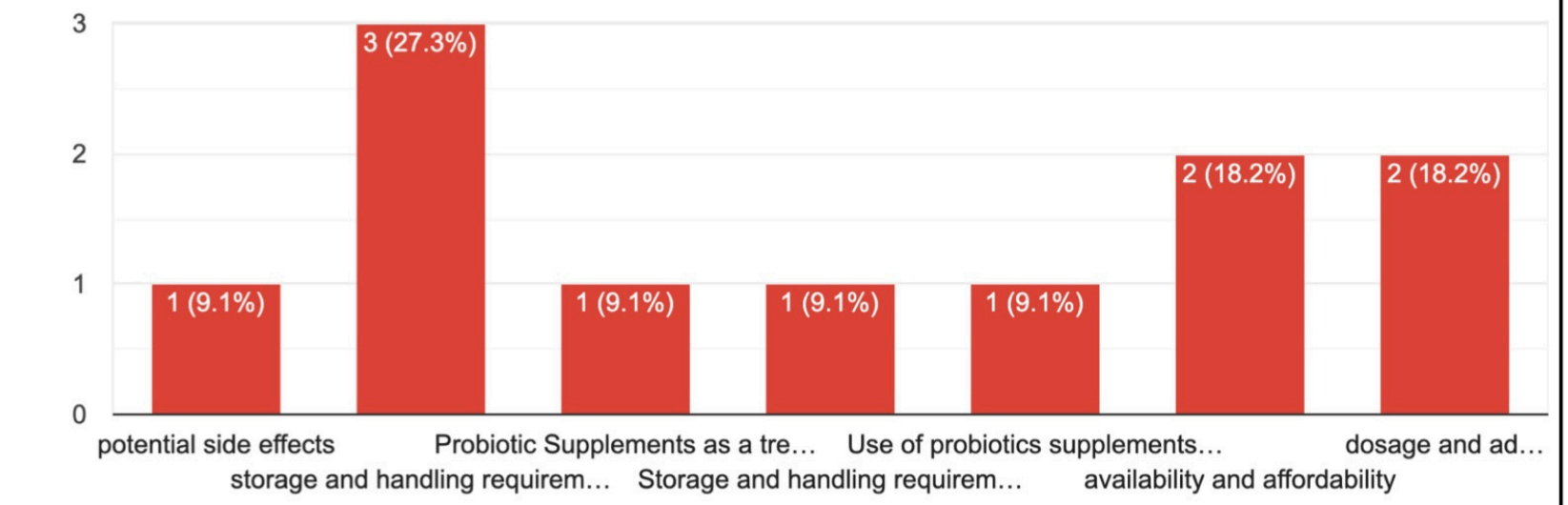


Figure 4-6.

Figure 4-6 shows that practitioners show interest in further acquisition of knowledge about various aspects of probiotic supplements. 'storage and handling requirements,' reflecting figure 4-4, is an area with the most responses (36.4%), followed by other areas such as the accurate usage of probiotic supplements (27.3%), availability and affordability (18.2%), potential side effects (9.1%) and storage and handling requirements (9.1%). Hence, further education, although focusing the most on storage and handling requirements, should cover the overview of probiotic supplements as a whole, expanding to all areas of the treatment.

Overview

The survey results clearly indicate that Probiotic Supplements are the area with the greatest need for educational improvement among all 4 treatments assessed. Practitioners showed significantly low familiarity across all key aspects, especially in storage and handling requirements, which received the lowest knowledge levels throughout the survey. Additional gaps were evident in knowledge of dosage and administration, side effects, and availability and affordability. Reflecting these results, practitioners also expressed strong interest in receiving training across multiple aspects of this treatment. Educational programs should therefore prioritize probiotic supplements, with a comprehensive approach that addresses all foundational areas to improve clinical readiness and confidence.